

(for which support was recently added).

- **Other features:** Shorewall provides many other features like traffic accounting, IPv6, MAC verification, lots of RPM/Debian packages, and even blacklisting of individual IP addresses or subnets.

How Shorewall works

Shorewall works through configuration files located in `/etc/shorewall` as mentioned earlier.

In order to work effectively, the following files are used.

1. **Interfaces:** These give detailed information of the physical interface being used for filtering the inbound and outbound traffic.
2. **Policy:** This defines the policies for connections between zones.
3. **Rules:** These define the connection establishment via exceptions to the main policy file.
4. **Zones:** All network zones are defined here.

Shorewall processes run in the background and are able to handle multiple IPs at a single point of time.

Shorewall packages

The following are the six main packages available as part of the Shorewall firewall.

- **Shorewall-Core:** This is the core package to install

Shorewall, Shorewall6, Shorewall-lite or Shorewall6-lite.

- **Shorewall-Comprehensive:** This package consists of everything needed to create the IPv4 firewall.
- **Shorewall6-Comprehensive:** This package consists of everything needed to create the IPv6 firewall.
- **Shorewall-lite:** This is a lightweight Shorewall version to run firewall scripts generated via the system that is already running Shorewall.
- **Shorewall6-lite:** This is a lightweight Shorewall6 version to run firewall scripts generated via a system already running Shorewall6.
- **Shorewall-init:** This is used to place the firewall in safe mode before running up the network interface. **END** 🐧

References

- [1] <http://shorewall.org>
- [2] http://shorewall.net/Documentation_Index.html
- [3] <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shorewall>

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